

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE
FOR

HOUSE BILL NO. 4476

By: Townley

COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE

An Act relating to economic development; making findings; defining terms; establishing program within the Oklahoma Film + Music Office; stating purpose of program; creating tracks within program; describing program tracks; prescribing required expenditure and cost amounts; authorizing use of program funds; prescribing authorized use of funds; providing for state contribution percentages; providing for priority of certain applications related to population; providing for collaboration with Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education; requiring annual reports; creating the Community Music Infrastructure and Events Development Revolving Fund; providing for authorized revenue sources; providing for expenditures from fund; providing for codification; and providing an effective date.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 2236-1 of Title 74, unless there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

1 The purpose of this act shall be to establish a comprehensive
2 program that supports both permanent music infrastructure and
3 community-based music festivals.

4 SECTION 2. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
5 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 2236-2 of Title 74, unless there
6 is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

7 The Legislature finds:

8 1. Music venues, rehearsal facilities, cultural districts, and
9 event spaces are essential components of Oklahoma's economy and
10 support the development of small businesses and skilled technical
11 workers;

12 2. Locally produced music festivals activate communities,
13 stimulate tourism, enhance economic vitality, and promote Oklahoma
14 as a destination for music;

15 3. Many Oklahoma communities lack year-round music
16 infrastructure necessary to support sustainable programming; and

17 4. Strengthening music infrastructure and festival capacity
18 will improve workforce readiness in sound engineering, lighting,
19 stage production, safety, hospitality, and event management.

20 SECTION 3. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
21 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 2236-3 of Title 74, unless there
22 is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

23 As used in this act:

1 1. "Community music infrastructure" means permanent or semi-
2 permanent facilities, structures, equipment, or improvements that
3 support music performance, rehearsal, or community music activity;

4 2. "Eligible applicant" includes municipalities, counties,
5 tribal nations, nonprofit organizations, Main Street programs, arts
6 councils, or privately operated venues or festival organizations
7 partnered with a nonprofit or public entity;

8 3. "Festival" or "music festival" means a community-organized
9 musical event presented over one (1) or more consecutive days that
10 includes live music components and is open to the public;

11 4. "Main Street community" means any community participating in
12 the Oklahoma Main Street Program administered by Oklahoma Main
13 Street within the Department of Commerce;

14 5. "Music venue" means an independently operated facility that
15 hosts live music performances on a regular basis;

16 6. "Office" means the Oklahoma Film + Music Office (OF+MO)
17 within the Department of Commerce;

18 7. "Rehearsal space" means any facility that may be
19 acoustically treated, used for music creation, practice, or
20 education available to the public; and

21 8. "Rural community" means a city or town having a population
22 not in excess of twenty-five thousand (25,000) persons or county not
23 in excess of two hundred fifty thousand (250,000) persons.

1 SECTION 4. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
2 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 2236-4 of Title 74, unless there
3 is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

4 A. The Community Music Infrastructure and Events Development
5 Program is hereby established within the Oklahoma Film + Music
6 Office.

7 B. The purpose of the program is to:

8 1. Develop, expand, and preserve year-round community music
9 infrastructure;

10 2. Support community-produced music festivals;

11 3. Improve workforce development opportunities through
12 partnerships with educational institutions and Oklahoma CareerTech;

13 4. Activate public spaces, Main Street districts, and tourism
14 destinations through music; and

15 5. Expand performance opportunities for Oklahoma musicians.

16 SECTION 5. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
17 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 2236-5 of Title 74, unless there
18 is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

19 A. The Community Music Infrastructure Program shall consist of
20 two tracks as follows:

21 1. Track A: Community Music Infrastructure Awards

22 For Track A, the Office shall ensure projects are capital-
23 worthy, not cosmetic and shall exclude from consideration projects
24 that should be handled privately.

1 For Track A, the Office shall also confirm construction or
2 renovation costs, permanent equipment, (sound, lighting, staging),
3 Americans with Disabilities Act compliance and safety upgrades and
4 the use of professional labor and materials.

5 2. Track B: Community Music Festivals

6 For Track B, the Office shall confirm that the event has market
7 viability to prevent funding of small, informal gatherings, and to
8 ensure that the minimum festival budget is in alignment with the
9 concept of a twenty-percent award.

10 The Office shall verify artist fees, production and staging
11 costs, security costs, logistics and permitting, market and
12 promotion, workforce or Higher Education/CareerTech engagement.

13 B. Awards pursuant to the provisions of this section may be
14 used for, but not limited to:

15 1. Capital improvements to music venues or community
16 facilities;

17 2. Electrical, plumbing, HVAC, or structural upgrades;

18 3. ADA accessibility improvements;

19 4. Safety and compliance measures, including fire suppression
20 and crowd-management systems;

21 5. Soundproofing and acoustic treatment;

22 6. Permanent staging, lighting, or audiovisual systems;

23 7. Conversion of public or underutilized buildings into music-
24 use facilities;

1 8. Rehearsal space creation or enhancement;

2 9. Permanent equipment inventory to be shared by community
3 festivals or venues; and

4 10. Infrastructure improvements in parks, Main Street
5 districts, or tourism areas.

6 SECTION 6. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
7 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 2236-6 of Title 74, unless there
8 is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

9 Track B – Community Music Festivals Awards

10 Awards pursuant to the provisions of this section may be used
11 for, but not limited to:

12 1. Development or expansion of community music festivals;

13 2. Temporary festival infrastructure that complements permanent
14 assets;

15 3. Workforce training in partnership with CareerTech or Higher
16 Education (audio, lighting, staging, event management);

17 4. Festival safety planning, ADA accommodations, and
18 accessibility improvements;

19 5. Event equipment rentals or site preparation; and

20 6. Artists, directors, managers, crew, and staff.

21 SECTION 7. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
22 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 2236-7 of Title 74, unless there
23 is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

1 The revenue to the Community Music Infrastructure and Events
2 Development Revolving Fund pursuant to Section 2352 of Title 68 of
3 the Oklahoma Statutes shall be allocated by the Oklahoma Film +
4 Music Office as follows each fiscal year:

5 1. Track A (Infrastructure): sixty percent (60%) of fund; and

6 2. Track B (Festivals/Events): forty percent (40%) of fund.

7 SECTION 8. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
8 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 2236-8 of Title 74, unless there
9 is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

10 A. Applications from rural communities shall receive priority
11 consideration.

12 B. Projects located within or benefiting an Oklahoma Main
13 Street district shall receive enhanced scoring.

14 C. Existing music festivals shall receive priority
15 consideration.

16 SECTION 9. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
17 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 2236-9 of Title 74, unless there
18 is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

19 The Office and the applicant shall collaborate with Oklahoma
20 CareerTech or Higher Education to develop and deliver workforce
21 training aligned with, but not limited to:

22 1. Audio engineering;

23 2. Lighting design;

24 3. Stagecraft and rigging;

1 4. Event operations;

2 5. Hospitality and tourism services; and

3 6. Safety and crowd management.

4 SECTION 10. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
5 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 2236-10 of Title 74, unless
6 there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

7 The Office shall submit an annual report to the Governor,
8 President Pro Tempore of the Oklahoma State Senate, and Speaker of
9 the Oklahoma House of Representatives that includes:

10 1. Number, type, and location of funded projects;

11 2. Infrastructure improvements completed;

12 3. Festivals or events activated;

13 4. Economic impact metrics;

14 5. Workforce development outcomes; and

15 6. Participation of Oklahoma musicians and vendors.

16 SECTION 11. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
17 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 2236-11 of Title 74, unless
18 there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

19 The Oklahoma Film + Music Office is authorized to:

20 1. Develop rules, scoring criteria, and evaluation processes;

21 2. Establish award cycles and reporting requirements; and

22 3. Adopt rules necessary for implementation of this act
23 pursuant to the Administrative Procedures Act.

SECTION 12. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 2236-12 of Title 74, unless there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

There is hereby created in the State Treasury a revolving fund for the Oklahoma Tax Commission to be designated the "Community Music Infrastructure and Events Development Revolving Fund". The fund shall be a continuing fund, not subject to fiscal year limitations, and shall consist of all monies received by the Oklahoma Tax Commission which are specifically required by law to be deposited in the fund, any public or private donations, contributions and gifts received for the benefit of the fund, and any amounts appropriated by the Oklahoma Legislature. All monies accruing to the credit of said fund are hereby appropriated and may be budgeted and expended by the Oklahoma Tax Commission for the purpose of paying rebates as provided in this act. Expenditures from said fund shall be made upon warrants issued by the State Treasurer against claims filed as prescribed by law with the Director of the Office of Management and Enterprise Services for approval and payment. Awards are less than the limitation provided, the excess rebate payments not utilized shall be added to subsequent fiscal year's limitations.

SECTION 13. This act shall become effective November 1, 2026.

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